

# Word Ladders

Change ONE letter each step — grades 2-3 · with clues

Name \_\_\_\_\_

Date \_\_\_\_\_

Use the clues. Change **one letter** each step to make the word that matches the clue.

## Ladder 1

**B E L T**

*Start here*

1

It rings: ding-dong!

2

Please \_\_\_\_ me a story.

3

The opposite of short

4

A happy dog wags it

**M A I L**

*Finish here*

## Ladder 2

**D E E P**

*Start here*

1

A wild animal; the male has antlers

2

Often the first word of a letter

3

A big furry animal that loves honey

4

A seed from a pod that you can eat

**L E A N**

*Finish here*

## Ladder 3

**B O L D**

*Start here*

1

A shiny yellow metal

2

The opposite of bad

3

What trees are made of

4

Soft stuff that comes from sheep

**P O O L**

*Finish here*

# Word Ladders

## Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

### Ladder 1

B E L T

*Start here*

1 B E L L

It rings: ding-dong!

2 T E L L

Please \_\_\_\_ me a story.

3 T A L L

The opposite of short

4 T A I L

A happy dog wags it

M A I L

*Finish here*

### Ladder 2

D E E P

*Start here*

1 D E E R

A wild animal; the male has antlers

2 D E A R

Often the first word of a letter

3 B E A R

A big furry animal that loves honey

4 B E A N

A seed from a pod that you can eat

L E A N

*Finish here*

### Ladder 3

B O L D

*Start here*

1 G O L D

A shiny yellow metal

2 G O O D

The opposite of bad

3 W O O D

What trees are made of

4 W O O L

Soft stuff that comes from sheep

P O O L

*Finish here*